

D324

Business of IT

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Midway through a CRM rollout for a credit union with 20 branches, the sponsor, who is well liked by the team, asks the project manager to add a mobile app feature. The PM estimates the feature would take two weeks. What should the PM do first?

- A. Add two weeks to the schedule and start work.
- B. Refuse the request, since scope can never change after planning.
- C. Document a change request, analyze its impact, and submit it for approval.
- D. Add the feature, since the sponsor requested it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A network upgrade for a county office has these tasks: A (3 days) must finish before B (5 days) and C (4 days); both B and C must finish before D (2 days). The county budgeted \$75,000. What is the shortest possible project duration?

- A. 9 days
- B. 10 days
- C. 5 days
- D. 14 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Using the same network (A 3 days, then B 5 days and C 4 days in parallel, then D 2 days), how much float does task C have?

- A. -1 day
- B. 0 days
- C. 1 day
- D. 4 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A data center migration for a regional hospital has a budget of \$200,000 and is 50% complete. Planned value to date is \$110,000 and actual cost is \$120,000. The team moved 40 servers last month. What is the cost performance index?

- A. 0.92
- B. 1.20
- C. 0.91
- D. 0.83

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project has earned value of \$90,000 and a CPI of 0.9. What is its actual cost?

- A. \$90,000
- B. \$100,000
- C. \$81,000
- D. \$10,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

On a website redesign for a bakery chain with 12 shops, a developer who loves animation adds a custom animated menu that no one requested and that is not in the scope statement. The client is friendly and pays on time. What is this called?

- A. Gold plating
- B. Scope creep
- C. Good customer service, since the client will like it
- D. A change request

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A software project for a shipping firm, which recently rebranded, faces a risk that a key vendor will miss delivery. The PM signs a contract with a penalty clause so the vendor pays for any delay costs. Which response is this?

- A. Accept
- B. Transfer
- C. Mitigate
- D. Avoid

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project team sees a chance to finish early and win a bonus, but lacks the skills to do it alone. It partners with another firm and splits the bonus. Which response is this?

- A. Mitigate
- B. Exploit
- C. Transfer
- D. Share

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A project team of 6 people at a university IT office adds 2 contractors from a firm in Boston. The project is in month four of nine. How many additional communication channels does this create?

- A. 13
- B. 26
- C. 28
- D. 2

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project has 45 communication channels. How many people are on the project?

- A. 9
- B. 90
- C. 10
- D. 45

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A PM at a logistics company, who earned her certification last year, has just received formal authorization from the sponsor, including high-level goals, budget, and her authority to use resources. Which document is this, and in which phase is it produced?

- A.** The project charter, in initiating
- B.** The project charter, in planning
- C.** The project management plan, in planning
- D.** The lessons learned register, in closing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A RACI chart for a cloud migration at a firm with 300 employees lists both the IT director and the CFO as Accountable for vendor selection. The CFO also chairs the budget committee. What is wrong?

- A.** Nothing; shared accountability builds buy-in.
- B.** Every stakeholder should be marked Accountable.
- C.** The CFO must be Accountable because of the committee role.
- D.** Only one person should be Accountable for a task.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

Midway through a CRM rollout for a credit union with 20 branches, the sponsor, ~~who is well liked by the team,~~ asks the project manager to add a mobile app feature. The PM estimates the feature would take two weeks. What should the PM do first?

Target word: first step for a scope change **Decides:** A new feature changes approved scope.

A	Dropped element	Skips analysis and approval.
B	Absolute language	Scope can change through the formal process.
C	Correct	Scope changes go through change control before work starts.
D	Camouflage	Sponsor goodwill does not bypass change control.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A network upgrade for a county office has these tasks: A (3 days) must finish before B (5 days) and C (4 days); both B and C must finish before D (2 days). ~~The county budgeted \$75,000.~~ What is the shortest possible project duration?

Target word: critical path length **Decides:** Longest path A-B-D = $3 + 5 + 2 = 10$.

A	Inverted operation	Takes the shorter path; B would still be running.
B	Correct	A-B-D is the longest path; A-C-D is 9.
C	Wrong stem number	The longest single task, not the path.
D	Adjacent category	Adds all tasks, ignoring that B and C run in parallel.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Using the same network (A 3 days, then B 5 days and C 4 days in parallel, then D 2 days), how much float does task C have?

Target word: float on a noncritical task **Decides:** Critical path 10; C's path 9.

A	Inverted operation	Subtracts in the wrong order.
B	Confusion set	Only critical-path tasks have zero float.
C	Correct	$10 - 9 = 1$ day.
D	Wrong stem number	C's duration, not its float.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A data center migration for a regional hospital has a budget of \$200,000 and is 50% complete. Planned value to date is \$110,000 and actual cost is \$120,000. ~~The team moved 40 servers last month.~~ What is the cost performance index?

Target word: CPI **Decides:** $EV = 50\% \times \$200,000 = \$100,000$; $CPI = EV / AC$.

A	Wrong stem number	PV / AC uses planned value in place of earned value.
B	Inverted operation	AC / EV flips the formula.
C	Confusion set	EV / PV is the SPI, a schedule measure.
D	Correct	$\$100,000 / \$120,000 = 0.83$; over budget.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A project has earned value of \$90,000 and a CPI of 0.9. What is its actual cost?

Target word: solve for AC **Decides:** $AC = EV / CPI$.

A	Dropped element	Assumes CPI is 1.
B	Correct	$\$90,000 / 0.9 = \$100,000$.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies by CPI instead of dividing.
D	Adjacent category	That is the size of the cost variance, not the actual cost.

6. Answer A Concept 4

On a website redesign for a bakery chain ~~with 12 shops~~, a developer who loves animation adds a custom animated menu that no one requested and that is not in the scope statement. ~~The client is friendly and pays on time.~~ What is this called?

Target word: name the problem **Decides:** The team added unrequested extras.

A	Correct	Team-added extras outside approved scope.
B	Confusion set	Scope creep usually comes from stakeholder requests growing the scope.
C	Camouflage	A friendly client does not make unapproved work acceptable.
D	Adjacent category	No request was made or approved.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A software project for a shipping firm, ~~which recently rebranded~~, faces a risk that a key vendor will miss delivery. The PM signs a contract with a penalty clause so the vendor pays for any delay costs. Which response is this?

Target word: name the response **Decides:** Financial impact shifts to a third party.

A	Adjacent category	Acceptance takes no action.
B	Correct	The penalty clause moves the cost of delay to the vendor.
C	Confusion set	Mitigation lowers likelihood or impact; the delay could still happen.
D	Inverted operation	Would remove the vendor or activity entirely.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A project team sees a chance to finish early and win a bonus, but lacks the skills to do it alone. It partners with another firm and splits the bonus. Which response is this?

Target word: response to a positive risk **Decides:** Opportunity pursued by partnering.

A	Confusion set	A threat response; this is an opportunity.
B	Adjacent category	Exploit makes sure the opportunity happens using your own resources.
C	Inverted operation	Transfer is the threat response that shifts a loss.
D	Correct	Partnering to capture an opportunity is sharing.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A project team of 6 people at a university IT office adds 2 contractors ~~from a firm in Boston. The project is in month four of nine.~~ How many additional communication channels does this create?

Target word: increase in channels **Decides:** 8 people: $8 \times 7 / 2 = 28$; 6 people: $6 \times 5 / 2 = 15$.

A	Correct	$28 - 15 = 13$ new channels.
B	Dropped element	$56 - 30$ skips dividing by 2.
C	Confusion set	The new total, not the increase.
D	Wrong stem number	The number of people added.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A project has 45 communication channels. How many people are on the project?

Target word: solve for n **Decides:** $n(n - 1) / 2 = 45$.

A	Adjacent category	$9 \times 8 / 2 = 36$.
B	Inverted operation	Multiplies by 2 instead of solving for n.
C	Correct	$10 \times 9 / 2 = 45$.
D	Wrong stem number	Treats channels as people.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A PM at a logistics company, ~~who earned her certification last year,~~ has just received formal authorization from the sponsor, including high-level goals, budget, and her authority to use resources. Which document is this, and in which phase is it produced?

Target word: document and phase **Decides:** Formal authorization with PM authority is the charter.

A	Correct	The charter authorizes the project and names the PM.
B	Confusion set	Right document, wrong phase.
C	Adjacent category	The detailed plan comes after the charter.
D	Inverted operation	Created at the end, not the start.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A RACI chart for a cloud migration ~~at a firm with 300 employees~~ lists both the IT director and the CFO as Accountable for vendor selection. ~~The CFO also chairs the budget committee.~~ What is wrong?

Target word: RACI rule violation **Decides:** Two people are Accountable for one task.

A	Inverted operation	Shared accountability means no one clearly owns the outcome.
B	Absolute language	Exactly one per task.
C	Camouflage	The committee role does not decide the RACI rule.
D	Correct	Single accountability avoids confusion over final decisions.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	5	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Change control	Any change to approved scope, schedule, or budget goes through a formal change request, impact analysis, and approval (often a change control board) before work begins.	Doing a small change right away because the sponsor asked for it.	A stakeholder asks for something new mid-project.
2	Critical path and float	The critical path is the longest path through the network and sets the shortest project duration; its tasks have zero float, and other tasks' float = critical length – their path length.	Taking the shortest path, or adding every task's duration together.	A dependency list with durations.
3	Earned value measures	$CV = EV - AC$ and $CPI = EV / AC$ for cost; $SV = EV - PV$ and $SPI = EV / PV$ for schedule; values below 1 (or negative) are unfavorable.	Dividing AC by EV, or using PV for cost performance.	EV, PV, and AC given with a question about cost or schedule.
4	Scope creep versus gold plating	Scope creep is uncontrolled growth in scope, often from stakeholder requests; gold plating is the team adding extras the customer did not ask for; both skip change control.	Calling team-added extras scope creep, or thinking gold plating is good service.	Who added the extra work and whether it was approved.
5	Risk response strategies	Negative risks: avoid, mitigate, transfer, accept. Positive risks: exploit, enhance, share, accept.	Calling insurance mitigation, or using a threat response for an opportunity.	An action on a risk and whether the risk is a threat or an opportunity.
6	Communication channels	$Channels = n(n - 1) / 2$, where n is the number of people; adding people increases channels much faster than headcount.	Forgetting to divide by 2, or reporting the total instead of the increase.	Team size changes and a question about communication paths.
7	Project phase activities	Initiating produces the charter and identifies stakeholders; planning builds the plan, WBS, and schedule; executing does the work; monitoring and controlling tracks variance; closing obtains acceptance, releases resources, and records lessons learned.	Placing the charter in planning or lessons learned only in execution.	A named document or activity and a question about the phase.
8	RACI assignments	Each task has exactly one Accountable person; Responsible people do the work; Consulted give input before; Informed are told after.	Assigning two people as Accountable.	A RACI chart with shared ownership.

Course scope (public description): Project Management - In this course, students will build on industry standard concepts, techniques, and processes to develop a comprehensive foundation for project management activities. During a project's life cycle, students will develop the critical skills necessary to initiate, plan, execute, monitor, control, and close a project. Students will apply best practices in areas such as scope management, resource allocation, project planning, project scheduling, quality control, risk management, performance measurement, and project reporting. This course prepares students for the following certification exam: CompTIA Project+.